Abel prize awarded to Furstenberg and Margulis

Terence Tao · 18 March 2020

https://terrytao.wordpress.com/2020/03/18/abel-prize-awarded-to-furstenberg-and-margulis/

tao2typ · converted to Typst 2026-10-14 (UTC)

Just a short post to note that this year's Abel prize has been awarded jointly to Hillel Furstenberg and Grigory Margulis for "for pioneering the use of methods from probability and dynamics in group theory, number theory and combinatorics". I was not involved in the decision making process of the Abel committee this year, but I certainly feel that the contributions of both mathematicians are worthy of the prize. Certainly both mathematicians have influenced my own work (for instance, Furstenberg's proof of Szemeredi's theorem ended up being a key influence in my result with Ben Green that the primes contain arbitrarily long arithmetic progressions); see for instance these blog posts mentioning Furstenberg, and these blog posts mentioning Margulis.

Comments (12)

Anonymous · 18 March 2020

comparatively

> **Danny Crane** · 25 June 2020
>
> I concur with you that the contributions of these two mathematicians deserves a prize. It is really noble of this two individuals to invest their time and skills in exploring these mathematical concepts. We are hoping that they will receive even more recognition even as they go on about their research. http://essaymojo.com/writing-services/write-my-economics-research-paper/

porton · 18 March 2020

How do you think, my algebraic general topology is also worth the prize or not?

> **Anonymous** · 18 March 2020
>
> I guess you will find out when you're 70+ !
>
> **Anonymous** · 18 March 2020
>
> This question could be asked only by a very modest person.
>
> > **porton** · 18 March 2020
> >
> > Something related to modesty vs honesty: https://www.quora.com/What-is-wrong-with-our-society-today/answer/Victor-Porton read item [2].

Anonymous · 19 March 2020

NY Times article:

riderriju · 20 March 2020

Grigory margulis also the winner of fields medal which is equivalent to nobel prize

 **Neez Duts** · 20 March 2020

Since being equivalent is presumably an equivalence relation, the abel prize is equivalent to the fields model. The only reasonable interpretation is that one wins the abel prize if and only if one wins the fields medal. Therefore, Furstenberg won the fields medal.

 **riderriju** · 15 June 2020

Sorry .but i also love Furstenberg .so please pardon me for my comments.

Hillel Furstenberg y Grigori Margulis, Premio Abel 2020 - Gaussianos · 25 March 2020

[…] Hillel Furstenberg es profesor emérito de la Universidad Hebrea de Jerusalén, y une este galardón al Premio Wolf que ya posee. Es conocido por su aplicación de la teoría de la probabilidad y la teoría ergódica en otras áreas de las matemáticas, como la teoría de números o los grupos de Lie. Entre otros logros matemáticos, simplificó bastante la demostración de un teorema de Endre Szemerédi, y su demostración ayudó mucho a Terence Tao y Ben Green a demostrar su teorema sobre números primos y progresiones aritméticas (lo cuenta el propio Tao aquí). […]

 **Anonymous** · 18 March 2021

No blogpost about this year's Abel Prize. Have you ever work with Lovasz?